

Expectation weighed heavy over the boy's head from a young age. The son of the Obi of the Rex's army, Eagrin always felt the eyes of others upon him. His father, Cormac, made his name in the warbands of Benzarian, whose purpose had shifted from waging endless war on Findal to stemming the undead plague pouring from the Spine. While proximal to the high class of Benzaria, Cormac understood his upbringing built his character.

Their family lived on a small farm just outside the city. Eagrin attended the commoner's school, toiled in the fields with his parents, and trained with his father. Through his childhood, he questioned their life; why should the Obi choose to live in squalor? Cormac would tell his son their purpose was to protect, that the golden sliver of divinity they'd been bestowed was not to be coveted, but to cast light on the path Benzaria was meant to take. Eagrin began to understand his father's ways.

He pushed himself, working harder, training harder. Eagrin studied under the masters of the Rex's army, learning how they waged war to keep peace. Over an illustrious career, Eagrin proved himself time and time again, rising until just below the rank of Obi, his father his only superior.

Unrest spread throughout Amox as Thayan wizards began to scheme and attempted to seize power in the time of tenuous peace among the once warring nations. The Benzarians met Thay on many fronts, doing their best to stymie them as they crept across the continent. Benzaria faced many losses, but none greater than in the Winter of 1529.

Under the cover of darkness and a bitter storm, a dozen Thayans descended upon the royal palace, slaying everyone inside with blasphemous magics. The Benzen lineage died quietly that night. By morning, the kingdom was stunned and sickened. For hundreds of years the family line had been unbroken, and now they were gone, leaving the Empire without leadership. Cormac found himself unable to act. He had failed his Rex. Eagrin tried to shake him from his stupor, but it was no use.

Eagrin could feel nothing but fury. As the remaining officers and councilors of the Empire bickered and cast blame, he gathered but a few things; his furs, his sword, and rhino from the stable. Alone he rode to Thay, driving forward as a blade through a heart. He returned weeks later, his rhino flanked by two stained bags on either side. In the town square, he slashed open each and dozens of heads rolled across the stone. Thay was no longer a threat.

People lined the streets in gratitude. Every officer, down to the Obi himself knelt before the one who had stopped their people from Thayan subjugation.

Amongst those assembled to decide succession, others tried to plead cases for their own merit to rule, but were loudly silenced by the Obi, and every other person of note in Benzaria. It was clear; Eagrin would be the first chosen Rex of Benzaria.

Over the next 20 years, through the peace he had taken with his own hands, Eagrin and his people enjoyed a life of little strife. He married and had 3 children. Cormac continued as Obi under his son, newly invigorated.

Only weeks ago, the threat of the Carrion King began to spread across Amox. It came for Benzaria quickly, a sea of undead growing in the distance. Eagrin understood his place as ruler; he was to take peace with his own hands as he did before. He embarked once again to the heart of the enemy, riding directly into the shambling horde. He cleaved through hundreds of undead, but their numbers seemed only to grow. Growing exhausted, his eyes found their supposed leader, a knight wreathed in shadow. Their fight was terrifying, the horde receding around them from the wretched strength of their blows.

Eagrin wrested the knight's sword away, and stood over to deliver the final strike, to end this threat before it could bring harm to his people. The knight thrust out a corrupted hand, burying it to the elbow beneath Eagrin's ribs. He lost vision, falling into darkness. When he awoke, the horde was in the distance, spilling into Benzaria. Eagrin dragged himself, sapped of all strength, to his home. Too enfeebled to fight, he took a hidden tunnel into the palace. As he arrived in the royal quarters, the scene from twenty years ago kept playing in his head.

Cormac lay on the ground, blades extending from his lifeless form. The gray stone was stained red, the palace guards ripped to pieces throughout its grounds. Eagrin could find no sign of his family as he limped through, screaming their names. He could feel himself waning as he burst through the doors to the throne room and found the knight brandishing a sword dripping with fresh blood. Under his watch, Benzaria had fallen in a day. Eagrin fell at his enemy's feet, tired. *Let this be it. No more.* He was ready to go, for what was left?

It was not to be. A brilliant white light flooded the room. Eagrin felt its searing heat envelope him as he lost vision, and eventually consciousness. He awoke, once again, on the shores of another land. This one, seemingly untouched by the undead blight. Dejected, Eagrin began to wander, learning had somehow made it to Yarin. With no way back to Amox, if there was anything left, he began his journey. The Carrion King was rumored to be on his way, so he would do everything he could to stop this land from falling.